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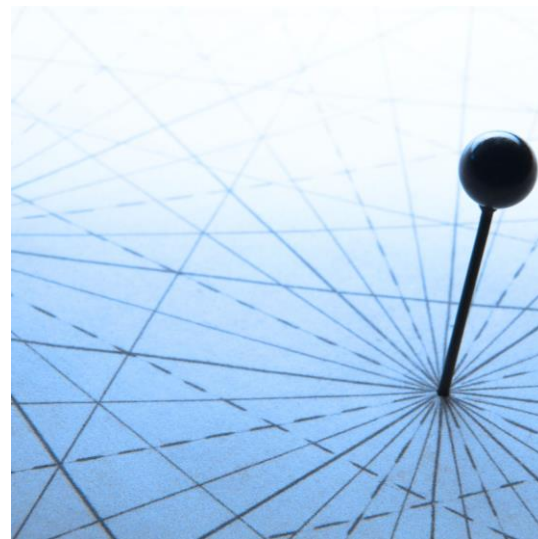
State Employment Leadership Network



Guide to Partner Mapping for Employment Networks

Adapted from Guide to
Partner Mapping for State
Employment Networks

Human Services Research
Institute (HSRI) & State
Employment Leadership
Network (SELN), 2025



**State Employment
Leadership Network**

UMass
Boston



 **NASDDDS**
National Association of State Directors
of
Developmental Disabilities Services

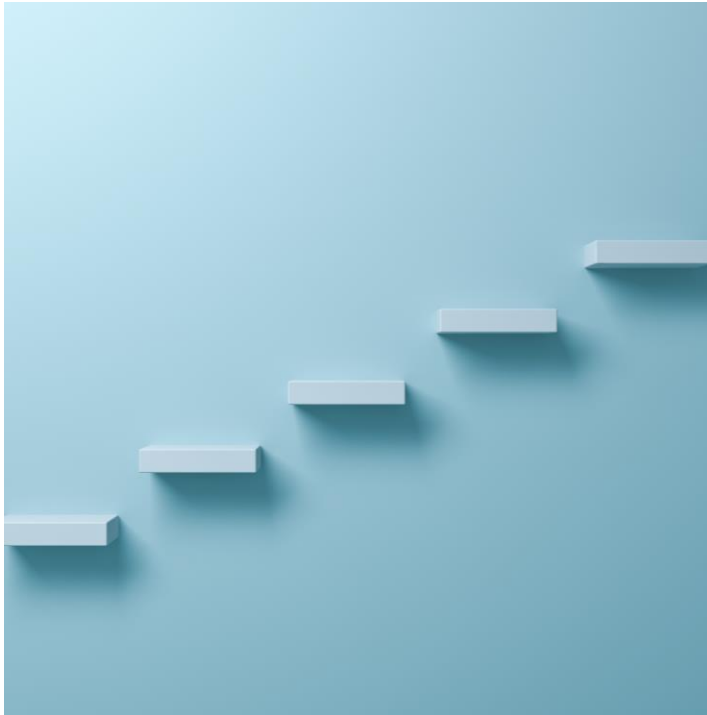
Purpose and Overview

- Define community/partner mapping
- Explain why mapping is essential for employment systems
- Strengthen partnerships and align services

Goals of Partner Mapping

- Identify new opportunities
- Improve collaboration
- Strengthen linkages across organizations

Step 1: Clarify Purpose and Reach



- Define your 'why' and focus area.
- Example: statewide, regional, or initiative-specific mapping

Step 2: Identify Workgroup Members

- Ideal group size: 5–10 people
- Include staff, agencies, advocacy groups, community orgs
- State systems can be very siloed – consider partners from your Medicaid Office, Data Managers, Tribal Liaisons, Quality Assurance Teams, Liaisons to various service providers, case managers, individuals and families.

Building Inclusive Workgroups

- Include lived experience voices – ensure
- Ensure diversity and cross system representation



Step 3: Assign Partner Mapping Roles

- Logistics – schedules and coordinates accommodation requests and supports member inquiries
- Facilitator – leads discussion
- Notetaker – records partners and ideas
- Rotate roles for shared ownership

Step 4: Conduct the Mapping Process

- Ask: Who should we engage, and why? Who do they support?
- What initiatives align with our mission?
- How can we connect with them?
- Use multiple meetings if needed

Exploring Gaps

- Identify hard-to-reach partners
- Use Social Drivers of Health (SDOH) & Health-Related Social Needs (HRSN)
- Explore housing, education, transportation, food security resources, financial stability, etc.



Step 5: Create the Partner Mapping List

- List organizations, regions of the state and populations supported.
- Contact information
- Include Best Ways to Engage with the Organization (Virtual, In-Person, Existing Meetings)
- Share list with workgroup for review

Step 6: Develop Engagement Strategies

- Identify new outreach strategies
- Use existing meetings/events
- Consider newsletters, listservs, and social media

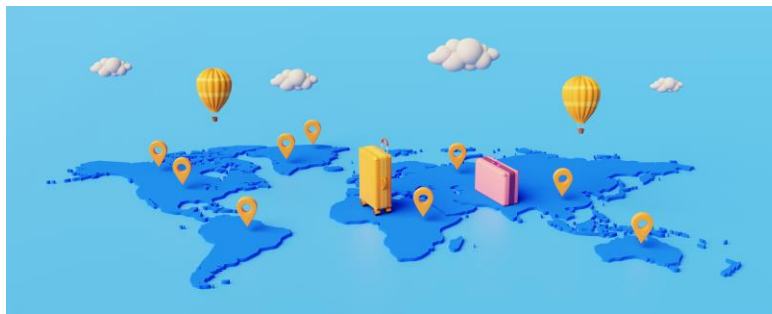


Culturally Responsive Engagement

- Understand partner cultures, organization structures and power dynamics
- Tailor outreach to build trust and sustainability
- Commit to sharing information in forms that fit the community, disseminate on a regular schedule and ensure communications are accessible.

Step 7: Maintain and Update the Map

- Decide who updates the list
- Establish frequency and responsibilities
- Keep partner engagement ongoing



Planning Template

- Define purpose, population, timeline
- Identify team and logistics
- Prepare materials and accommodations

Tools and Resources

- Google Maps
- Community-based organization (CBO) databases
- Workforce and education partnerships



Summary and Key Takeaways

- Community mapping =
connection + collaboration
- Build and sustain relationships for long-term success.

Reflection and Discussion

- Who are potential partners in your region that remain untapped?
- What next steps can you take?
- Questions?

Acknowledgments

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- ***Authors: Saska Rajcevic (HSRI), Amy Huppi (ICI), and Reg Sisneros (NASDDDS)***



Human Services
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State Employment Leadership Network

The SELN is a place for states to connect, collaborate, and create cross-community support regarding pressing employment-related issues at state and federal levels for individuals with developmental disabilities.

The SELN was launched in 2006 as a joint program of the National Association of State Directors of Developmental Disabilities Services and the Institute for Community Inclusion at the University of Massachusetts Boston.

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